

Category 2 ambulance response

Forecast for September 2026 · data through August 2026

Category 2 ambulance response is forecast to deteriorate at the next release, from 28.9 min to 30.9 min. The model's expected deterioration is mainly due to the usual month-to-month seasonal movement, partly offset by an improving underlying trend. The current projection is off course for 25 minutes during 2026/27. Sustained favourable/adverse provider signals: 0/2.

LATEST · AUGUST 2026

28.9 min

No archived pre-release forecast

OUTLOOK · SEPTEMBER 2026

30.9 min

80% range 24.2 min–36.1 min

ACTUAL

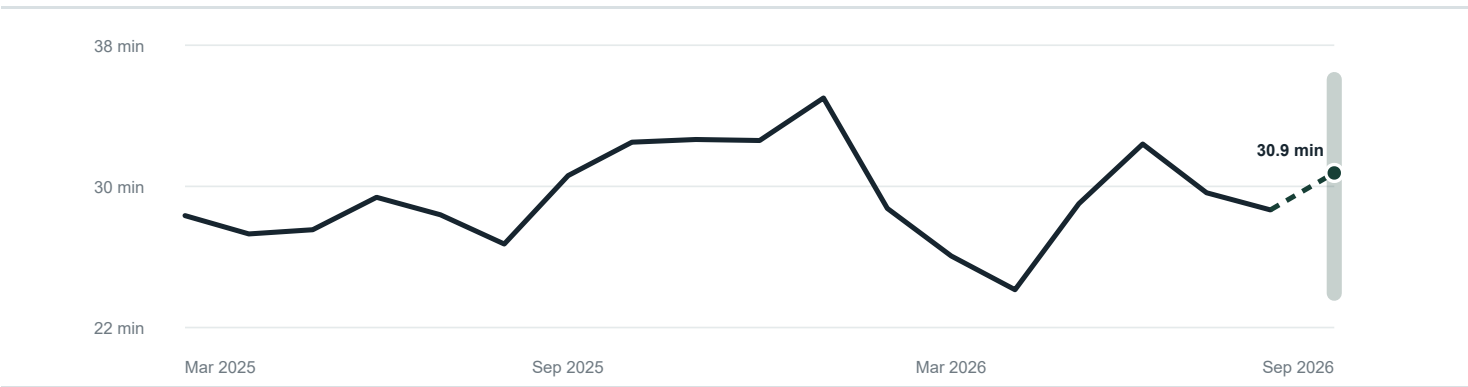
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Not yet released

Off course · 25 minutes during 2026/27

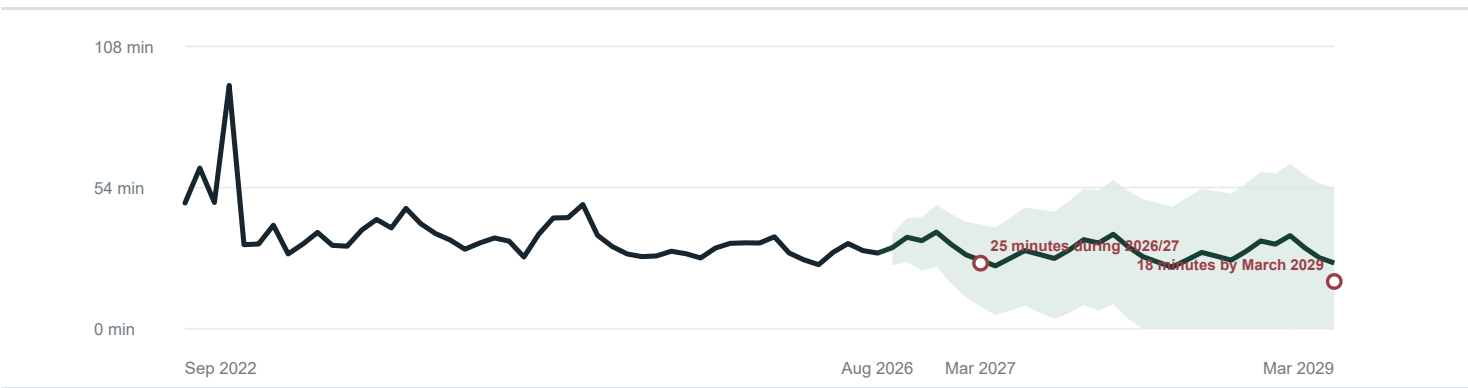
Recent performance and next release

The vertical band is the 80% expected range.



Longer-term outlook and milestones

Descriptive projection; not forced to meet targets.



Benchmark: 18-minute standard. 1.1 min above milestone

Data: NHS England Ambulance Quality Indicators. **Targets:** Medium Term Planning Framework interim target · Medium Term Planning Framework final target

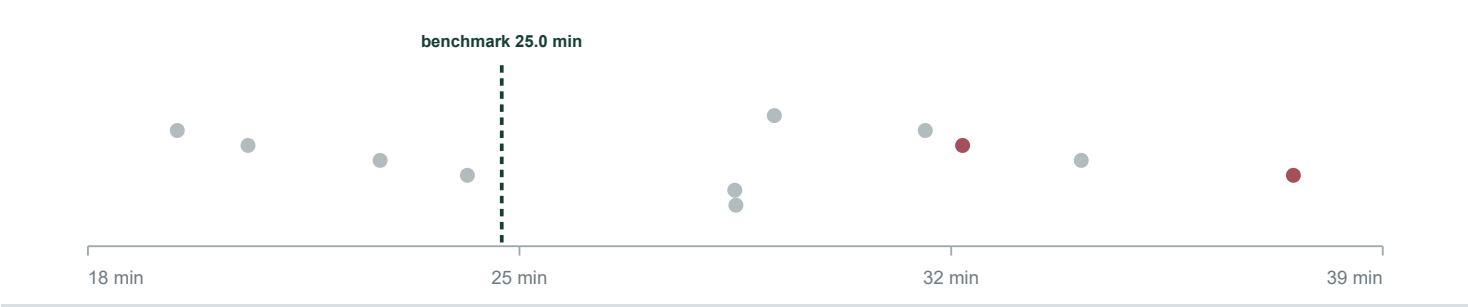
Method: Backtest-weighted ensemble of current-level seasonal movement, damped annual drift and a damped recent seasonal trend; at least 2 components are required. The final fit uses 109 consecutive months. Accuracy is tested on 36 rolling one-month-ahead forecasts. The 80% range uses empirical historical error quantiles from 36 forecast errors. Weights use inverse rolling RMSE and are shrunk toward equal weights. The pre-release commentary compares the current-level seasonal component with the combined forecast. Provider distribution and trajectory watch are shown on page 2.

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Distribution and trajectory watch · August 2026

Provider distribution

Latest reported performance across providers. This is a comparison of current levels, not a measure of whether each provider is improving or deteriorating.



Trajectory watch

Signals show sustained departures from each provider's own archived outlook. A low performer can be improving, and a high performer can be deteriorating. Status: Sufficient national and provider history.

11 providers assessed	0 sustained favourable	2 sustained adverse	9 without an active signal
Largest sustained favourable moves No qualifying signal.		Largest sustained adverse moves SOUTH WESTERN AMBULANCE SERVICE NHS FOUNDATION TRUST Latest 37.7 min · 6 consecutive releases assessed historically simulated 5.3 min SIX-MONTH GAP LONDON AMBULANCE SERVICE NHS TRUST Latest 32.4 min · 6 consecutive releases assessed historically simulated 3.6 min SIX-MONTH GAP	

Trajectory-watch rule. Six consecutive release surprises are compared with forecasts made before each release. A signal requires a material average gap, at least five of six months in the same direction, and the latest month confirming that direction. These are screening prompts—not league tables, causal estimates or judgements of provider quality.